

Gustav Achterberg

Character Dossier

Boisterous, generous, easily bored ring announcer of the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon

Overview

Gustav Achterberg is a ring announcer living in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon. Gustav is 48 years old, originally from the Ninth Terrace, and is known around the Reading Well as boisterous, generous, easily bored. In conversation Gustav speaks in short, clipped sentences and dislikes being rushed.

Background

Gustav arrived in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon 14 years ago after leaving the Ninth Terrace under circumstances Gustav describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Order of Wet Pages; the second was the one that stuck. Today Gustav works as a ring announcer near the Stacks of Ash and is paid, when paid at all, in ink-weights.

Gustav learned the trade from Zelda Blackwater, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Gustav's life is with Torvald Norwood, over a matter neither will explain. The person Gustav trusts most is Zora Duskmere.

Current goal: to keep Zora Duskmere out of trouble for one full season. Greatest fear: being forgotten.

Personality and speech

Temperament: boisterous, generous, easily bored.

Speech pattern: Gustav speaks in short, clipped sentences and dislikes being rushed.

Tells: when lying, Gustav mentions Tuesday the mouse for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Gustav Achterberg
Role	ring announcer
Home	the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon
Hometown	the Ninth Terrace
Age	48
Favourite dish	hand-rolled green tomato chutney
Pet	Tuesday, a mouse

<i>Lucky number</i>	422
<i>Workshop password</i>	cove-oak
<i>Mentor</i>	Zelda Blackwater
<i>Rival</i>	Torvald Norwood
<i>Closest friend</i>	Zora Duskmere

Secret

Gustav has never told Zelda Blackwater that the famous 'accident' was deliberate.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Gustav: I am the ring announcer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Gustav: Hand-rolled green tomato chutney. Do not tell Torvald I said so.

Visitor: Is Tuesday yours?

Gustav: Tuesday belongs to nobody. Tuesday tolerates me. Lucky number is 422, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 39

The weather turned. Gustav moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about whether the bridge will hold. Gustav repaired the cracked compass at the cataloguers' gallery for Matthias, who paid in 64 ink-weights and a long story about the missing shipment. Gustav was hired to carry a signal flag from the cataloguers' gallery to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gustav was hired to carry a glass float from the cataloguers' gallery to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 2, spring of year 39

Gustav won 8 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney. Hollis came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Gustav suspects Zora and is probably right. Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 3, winter of year 39

Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Gustav repaired the iron kettle at the sluice gates for Ignatius, who paid in 24 ink-weights and a long story about the comet. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Gustav found a signal flag half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 4, summer of year 39

Gustav spent the day counting stock at the Reading Well: 73 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Gustav was hired to carry a pair of spectacles from the Reading Well to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gustav found a brass lantern half-buried near the Reading Well and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 5, summer of year 39

The weather turned. Gustav moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the new curfew. Gustav repaired the grain scale at the Archivist's cell for Yannick, who paid in 78 ink-weights and a long story about the quarantine. The weather turned. Gustav moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the singing at the docks. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the Archivist's cell. Gustav pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 6, summer of year 39

A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the sluice gates, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone. At the sluice gates, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Gustav was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the sluice gates to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 7, autumn of year 39

Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the sluice gates. Gustav pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the quarantine reached the sluice gates. Gustav pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the sluice gates, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 8, winter of year 39

A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Gustav won 29 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney. Gustav repaired the glass float at the Archivist's cell for Marisol, who paid in 23 ink-weights and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. Ignatius came by asking about the old tunnels. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 9, spring of year 40

Gustav spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 54 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the sluice gates. Gustav pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 10, spring of year 40

Gustav spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 40 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Gustav spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 60 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. The weather turned. Gustav moved the grain scale indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the singing at the docks.

Entry 11, autumn of year 40

Gustav was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the Reading Well to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Gustav suspects Zora and is probably right. Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 12, spring of year 40

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Gustav won 90 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney. Ignatius came by asking about the missing shipment. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead. Gustav closed early, walked to the Stacks of Ash, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance.

Entry 13, autumn of year 40

The weather turned. Gustav moved the copper pipe indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the singing at the docks. Gustav closed early, walked to the cataloguers' gallery, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance. Gustav found a bolt of linen half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 14, winter of year 40

A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Gustav moved the ledger indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the price of lamp oil. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Gustav won 77 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney.

Entry 15, summer of year 40

Gustav found a bundle of letters half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Gustav repaired the cracked compass at the sluice gates for Mara, who paid in 13 ink-weights and a long story about the rumour of a second well. At the sluice gates, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 16, summer of year 40

The weather turned. Gustav moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about who really won the regatta. Gustav was hired to carry a signal flag from the Archivist's cell to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Gustav suspects Zora and is probably right. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the Archivist's cell; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 17, spring of year 40

Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. Gustav closed early, walked to the Reading Well, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance. Gustav won 56 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney.

Entry 18, winter of year 40

Gustav closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance. Rumours about the census reached the Reading Well. Gustav pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Gustav closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance. Gustav spent the day counting stock at the Reading Well: 28 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short. The weather turned. Gustav moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 19, autumn of year 40

A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Gustav found a hand bell half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 20, summer of year 40

Gustav closed early, walked to the Stacks of Ash, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance. Gustav closed early, walked to the Stacks of Ash, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance. Gustav won 12 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney. Gustav was hired to carry a iron kettle from the Archivist's cell to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 21, winter of year 40

Gustav closed early, walked to the Stacks of Ash, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance. At the Reading Well, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. Olwen came by asking about the tariff on salt. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 22, winter of year 40

A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the new curfew. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 23, autumn of year 40

Gustav was hired to carry a tin whistle from the Reading Well to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gustav repaired the brass lantern at the Reading Well for Teodora, who paid in 82 ink-weights and a long story about the singing at the docks. A dispute over the comet flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the Reading Well; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Gustav repaired the pair of spectacles at the Reading Well for Dashiell, who paid in 49 ink-weights and a long story about the census.

Entry 24, summer of year 40

Isadora came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the census flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Gustav moved the tin whistle indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the census. The weather turned. Gustav moved the glass float indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the new curfew. Katarina came by asking about the comet. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 25, spring of year 41

A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Hollis came by asking about the missing shipment. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead. Gustav won 3 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney.

Entry 26, summer of year 41

The weather turned. Gustav moved the wax seal indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the old tunnels. Rurik came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Gustav moved the tin whistle indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the quarantine. Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 27, spring of year 41

At the Reading Well, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone. Gustav closed early, walked to the cataloguers' gallery, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance. Rurik came by asking about the census. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Gustav suspects Zora and is probably right.

Entry 28, autumn of year 41

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the Reading Well, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. Bram came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 29, summer of year 41

Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the Archivist's cell. Gustav pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Gustav repaired the bolt of linen at the Archivist's cell for Brigid, who paid in 26 ink-weights and a long story about the harvest count. Gustav spent the day counting stock at the Archivist's cell: 73 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short.

Entry 30, autumn of year 41

Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Gustav for the

password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 31, spring of year 41

Gustav found a cracked compass half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Gustav found a clockwork bird half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 32, winter of year 41

Gustav repaired the spool of wire at the cataloguers' gallery for Brigid, who paid in 78 ink-weights and a long story about who really won the regatta. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the cataloguers' gallery. Gustav pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Gustav was hired to carry a iron kettle from the cataloguers' gallery to the Stacks of Ash without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 33, winter of year 41

A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the Stacks of Ash; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the census flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the Stacks of Ash; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rhoswen came by asking about the singing at the docks. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead. Gustav repaired the iron kettle at the Stacks of Ash for Isadora, who paid in 24 ink-weights and a long story about the price of lamp oil. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 34, autumn of year 41

At the Archivist's cell, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the Archivist's cell; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 35, spring of year 41

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Gustav found a iron kettle half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Gustav suspects Zora and is probably right. The weather turned. Gustav moved the pair of spectacles indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the rumour of a second well.

Entry 36, spring of year 41

Gustav found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the Reading Well and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Gustav suspects Zora and is probably right. Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. The weather turned. Gustav moved the cracked compass indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the rumour of a second well. At the Reading Well, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 37, spring of year 42

A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the Stacks of Ash; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Gustav was hired to carry a tin whistle from the Stacks of Ash to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. The weather turned. Gustav moved the coil of rope indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the old tunnels. Gustav won 13 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney.

Entry 38, spring of year 42

Gustav was hired to carry a ledger from the Stacks of Ash to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gustav was hired to carry a glass float from the Stacks of Ash to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gustav spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 90 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Gustav found a clockwork bird half-buried near the Stacks of Ash and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 39, summer of year 42

A stranger asked Gustav for the password to the workshop. Gustav laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Gustav repaired the bundle of letters at the Stacks of Ash for Bram, who paid in 11 ink-weights and a long story about the old tunnels. Gustav spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 24 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short.

Entry 40, spring of year 42

Gustav was hired to carry a coil of rope from the Reading Well to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gustav repaired the coil of rope at the Reading Well for Emeric, who paid in 40 ink-weights and a long story about the singing at the docks. The weather turned. Gustav moved the bundle of letters indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the tariff on salt. At the Reading Well, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Gustav suspects Zora and is probably right.

Entry 41, autumn of year 42

Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Gustav suspects Zora and is probably right. Kestrel came by asking about the comet. Gustav said nothing useful and made tea instead. Gustav was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the sluice gates to the Archivist's

cell without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the missing shipment. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 42, spring of year 42

Gustav closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Tuesday followed at a distance. The weather turned. Gustav moved the pair of spectacles indoors, fed Tuesday, and wrote three lines to Zelda about the harvest count. Gustav won 84 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney. At the Reading Well, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by weight alone. Gustav was hired to carry a wax seal from the Reading Well to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 43, summer of year 42

Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Gustav spent the day counting stock at the cataloguers' gallery: 60 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short. Zelda visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Gustav suspects Zora and is probably right.

Entry 44, summer of year 42

Gustav was hired to carry a tin whistle from the cataloguers' gallery to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Gustav repaired the bolt of linen at the cataloguers' gallery for Calloway, who paid in 74 ink-weights and a long story about the tax on doors. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the tax on doors. Gustav read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 45, winter of year 43

A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Gustav and Torvald outside the Reading Well; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Gustav won 54 ink-weights from Torvald on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on hand-rolled green tomato chutney. Gustav was hired to carry a iron kettle from the Reading Well to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Gustav repaired the clockwork bird at the Reading Well for Ursula, who paid in 50 ink-weights and a long story about the right way to mend a net. At the Reading Well, Gustav taught Zora how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone.